

Sandy the Crab's Sideways Tag

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



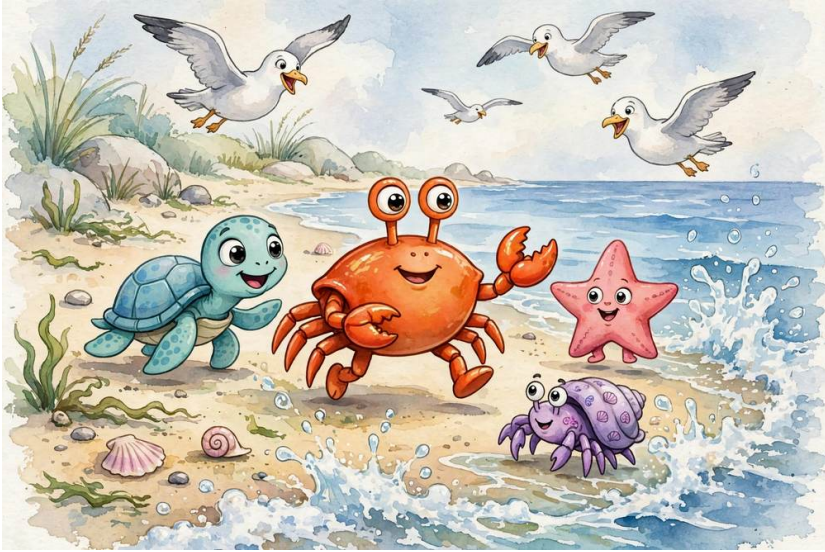
Sandy was a small orange crab. She lived on a sunny beach. Sandy loved playing tag. Her friends played every afternoon. Wally the whelk and Perla the prawn. They ran across the sand. "Tag! You are it!" But Sandy had a problem. Crabs cannot run straight. They can only walk sideways. Scuttle scuttle scuttle. When Sandy tried to run forward, she tumbled. Plop! Right into the sand. Sandy felt embarrassed. Her cheeks turned red under her shell. "I cannot play tag right," she said. She felt left out. She sat by a rock and watched.



Her friend Perla the prawn swam over. "Why so sad, Sandy?" asked Perla. "My legs only go sideways," said Sandy. "I am too slow for tag." Perla wiggled her whiskers. "Then let us play sideways tag!" she said. "Sideways is a super way." "Sideways is a super way." Sandy repeated it softly. "Sideways is a super way." It became their game-day cheer. "Sideways is a super way."



Perla called the friends together. "New rule!" she announced. "Today, everyone plays tag sideways." "Just like Sandy." The friends tried it. Scuttle scuttle! Wally wobbled sideways. Perla zigzagged sideways. Everyone giggled. It was much sillier. And much more fun. Sandy was the fastest sideways walker of all. Scuttle scuttle scuttle! "Tag! You are it!" she cried. She tagged Wally. She tagged Perla. Sandy felt proud. She felt included. Her sideways walk was a superpower.



Can you scuttle like Sandy? Stand up and step sideways. Scuttle scuttle scuttle! Now sit down, nice and slow. They played sideways tag until the tide came in. Splash! The waves tickled their toes. Sandy taught everyone her best scuttle. Left, right, left, right. "Sideways is a super way!" they chanted. Even the seagulls watched and laughed. It was the best game day ever.



When the sun sank into the sea, they rested. Sandy tucked into a cozy rock pool. Perla floated beside her. "Best tag game ever," whispered Perla. "Thanks to your super sideways," she added. Sandy smiled sleepily. "Sideways is a super way," she yawned. The waves rocked her gently. Shhh, shhh, shhh. And Sandy slept, safe in her pool.

Moral: *What makes you different can make the game better for everyone.*

The End